Mate Dolidze

GAMEPLAY PROGRAMMER

Gameplay Programmer with 4 years of professional Unity experience and 2 shipped titles, developing gameplay systems, AI and tools. Now focused on Unreal Engine C++ development, specializing in AI Systems, Gameplay Frameworks and player abilities.

WORK HISTORY

Unreal / C++ ***FIRST-PERSON STEALTH PROTOTYPE*** *(Solo Project, 2025)*

- Designed and implemented a custom AI system combining **Behavior Trees**, **State Trees**, and **Perception** to drive enemy behavior such as patrol, search, lurk and pursuit.
- Extended **UE5's AI Perception** with a **custom Safe-zone sense**, enabling context-aware detection and systemic stealth scenarios.
- Build an **object interaction and inventory framework** supporting item pickup, storage, and environment-based distractions to influence AI behavior.
- Focused on **systemic emergent gameplay**, integrating perception-driven logic to increase player agency and replayability.

Unreal / C++ ***MAGE ABILITY DEMO*** *(Solo Project, 2025)*

- Developed a modular **Ability System**, supporting multiple player abilities: (Heal, Teleport, Beam, Projectiles)
- Implemented gameplay logic for ability selection, targeting and activation using **Enhanced Input** and custom state handling.
- Integrated ability animations and timed effects via **Animation Notifies** to ensure precise synchronization between visuals and gameplay events.
- Created custom visual effects for each ability using **Niagara System,** enhancing clarity and player feedback.

Unity / C# ***ALPACA DASH*** *(Gameplay Programmer at Kind Knight Games, 2023-2025)*

- Built a **modular**, **ScriptableObject**-driven tutorial framework with interactive UI highlights and event-driven triggers. Used by designers to author tutorials without engineering support, accelerating onboarding iteration and reducing dev hands-off.
- Automated environment import pipeline with **Blender Python scripts** and **Unity editor tooling**, streamlining scene setup and asset transfer. Saved an estimated **20+ hours per environment** across 4 shipped maps (~900 imported models) reducing repetitive artist workload.
- Engineered a flexible camera framework using **Cinemachine** and custom blend logic to automatically adapt perspectives to gameplay states. Improved clarity in high-speed racing and reduced designer camera setup time.
- Developed a modular runtime mesh-swapping system leveraging **Unity Addressables** and cloud asset hosting. Enabled thousands of cosmetic variations while cutting client build size.

Unity / C# ***DEFI-LAND*** *(Gameplay Programmer at Kind Knight Games, 2021-2023)*

- Implemented player-driven map editing with backend persistence via API integration. Boosted retention and engagement by enabling users to customize farms and social spaces with shareable layouts.
- Created a designer-configurable shooting gallery with variable target behaviors, power-ups, and backend-driven round rules. Increased session variety and extended average playtime.
- Built a modular fishing system with procedurally generated input sequences, dynamic scoring and tension-based mechanics. Provided repeatable, skill-based gameplay that became a key causal loop for players.

Unity / C# ***MERGE-HEROES*** *(Gameplay Programmer at AppIdea, 2020-2021)*

- Worked on a mobile RPG, merger-type game, implementing different character ability behaviors and creating VFX for them.

EDUCATION

Mathematics & Computer Science **(MACS)**	Free university of Tbilisi 2017-2021
Game Development Program **(Unreal Engine)**	Vertex School 2024

SKILLS

Programming Languages: C#, C++, Blueprint Scripting, Python
Game Engines: Unity, Unreal Engine 5
Misc: Performance Profiling, Memory management, Refactoring, debugging working with large codebases, Git, Perforce